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Glossary of Influence Plays™

Influence Play /infloōəns plā/ *n.*
1. A stratagem, irreducibly unique, employed by a person, organization or surrogate to improve mutual or competitive advantage through methods and means of influence. (***Syn.*** Play, Influence Strategy, Influence Stratagem).

INDEPENDENT

Pass PS
To bail out. The strategic withdrawal from a marketplace or matter.

TEST

Trial Balloon TB
To test an idea. The conditional preview of preliminary ideas or tentative plans.

Ping PG
To hint and hide. The oblique reference or suggestion by a player of implied interests or positions.

Pause PZ
To wait and watch. The deliberate suspension of activity or interaction.

DIVERT

Deflect DF
To dodge a point. The evasion of another player's query or attack.

Red Herring RD
To send off course. The luring of a player away from its preferred position or plan.

FRAME

Label LB
To make something stick. The application of a memorable word, phrase or symbol, self-given or attributed to another.

Screen SN
To play with a prop. The borrowing of issues, ideas, events or symbols.

Recast RC
To reorder and restate. The reinterpretation of an action, event, information, message or symbol.

Filter FI
To edit and omit. The selective transmission of information or meaning.

FREEZE

Lantern LN
To beat the bad news. The preemptive disclosure by a player of flaws, mistakes or potential controversy.

Disco DX
To concede then proceed. A concession or sacrifice by a player to preserve its policy or position.

Mirror MI
To reflect the facts. The introduction of information to support or contradict another player's position.

Bear Hug BG
To agree overtly. The conspicuous support of another player's position or message.

Jam JM
To gum up the works. The disabling or disorganization of a player's activities or communications.

PRESS

Fiat FT
To say it, sans spin. The declaration of an idea, opinion, fact or information without interpretation or bias.

Challenge CH
To call for change. The invitation or exhortation by a player to make, take or modify a position.

Crowd CW
To copy and catch up. The adoption or mimicry of another player's position or idea.

Draft DR
To borrow then beat. The adoption of and improvement upon a leader's idea or agenda.

PREEMPT

Crazy Ivan CZ
To rush a rival. The deliberate acceleration by a threatened player of an impending attack or problem.

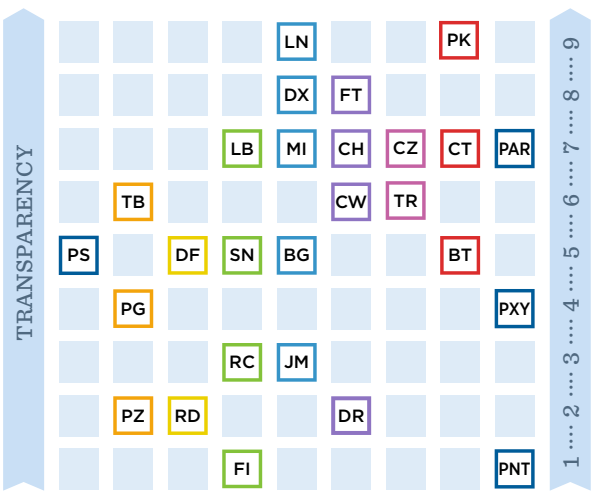
Trump TR
To steal the thunder. Action or communication that usurps another player's position or platform.

PROVOKE

Peacock PK
To parade about. The unsolicited promotion of a novelty or innovation.

Call Out CT
To chide or deride. Mockery or moral indignation directed at a player or its position.

Bait BT
To taunt and trap. The provocation of a player to act against its self-interest.

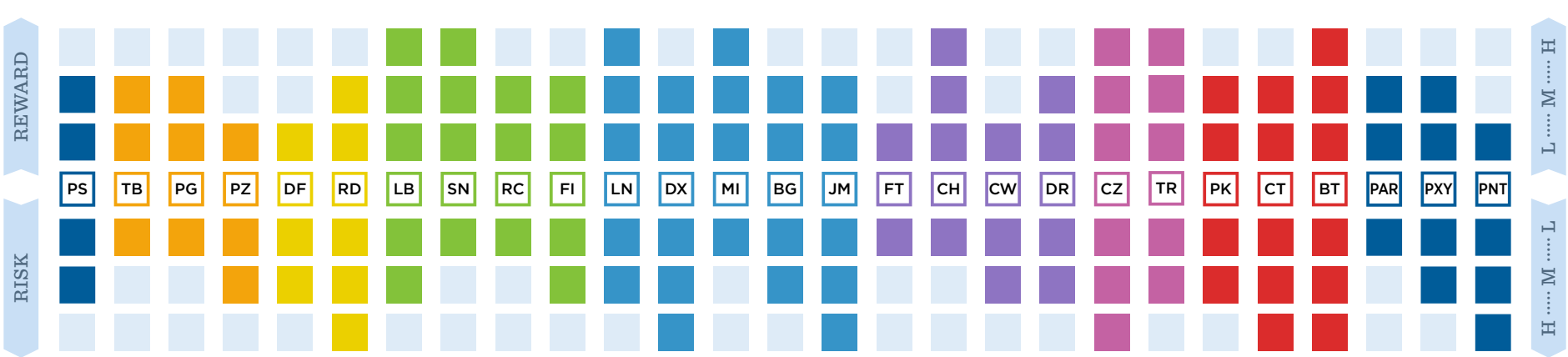


SURROGATES

Partner PAR
A coequal. A surrogate who operates as a peer, typically receiving reciprocal support in pursuit of a common purpose.

Proxy PXY
A hired gun. A surrogate who advocates for another player, typically for consideration.

Plant PNT
A secret ally. A surrogate whose methods and motives are unattributed or unknown to others.



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